but it illustrates the point nicely. In the following listing, it's added to the start of the middleware pipeline and configured to respond only to the `"/"` path.

Listing 4.4 Adding `WelcomePageMiddleware` to the pipeline

```
WebApplicationBuilder builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);
WebApplication app = builder.Build();

app.UseWelcomePage("/");                    ❶
app.UseDeveloperExceptionPage();
app.UseStaticFiles();
app.UseRouting();                           ❷

app.MapGet("/", () => "Hello World!");      ❷

app.Run();
```

❶ WelcomePageMiddleware handles all requests to the "/" path and returns a sample HTML response.

❷ Requests to "/" will never reach the endpoint middleware, so this endpoint won't be called.

Even though you know that the endpoint middleware can *also* handle the `"/"` path, `WelcomePageMiddleware` is earlier in the pipeline, so it returns a response when it receives the request to `"/"`, short-circuiting the pipeline, as shown in figure 4.13. None of the other middleware in the pipeline runs for the request, so none has an opportunity to generate a response.

